

# Thin Is In

**Actually, the thin client idea has existed for a long time, but it hasn't been the "in thing" for businesses in India—yet. Here's a look at why "Thin" might be just what you're looking for**

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There are three basic computing needs for any business. First, and before anything else, businesses need stability in their IT infrastructure. Downtimes are the mother of all evils in any business—they negatively impact productivity, and means that your employees are sitting around waiting for IT problems to be fixed. Secondly, we have data security, and we need not emphasise how important that is in today's competitive world. And last but by no means least, we have costs, and it's but obvious that the lower the cost of infrastructure and the total cost of ownership (TCO), the better for any business out there.

A solution that fulfils all three of the above needs has been available for a long time now, but not many have come forward to adopt it. Why? We'll let you, all the small and medium-sized businesses out there, answer that for yourself.

## Cut The Fat

No, we don't mean to tell you to fire all the department heads (though that would reduce the outgoings from your coffers considerably). We mean this in terms of IT infrastructure.

Let's take the example of a typical medium-sized company with around 200 employees. Let's now say only 60 of them have any need for a computer, and so you have 60 computers in the office.

If you divide the users into groups, you'll see groups like Accounts, Sales, Inventory, and so on. Once you've done that, you will realise that all employees who fall under the "Accounts" group have mostly similar requirements, yet their computer configurations will vary. It's not surprising to find that some will have Pentium 4-based systems (or their AMD equivalents), running Windows XP, while others will have Pentium II-class systems running Windows 98. Why the discrepancy?

Typically, employees in a company get better PCs based either on the number of years they've worked in the company, or on seniority. It may not be planned that way, or even be noticeable at first, but our Indian ideals of respecting age and respecting seniority are all-pervasive. As a business, however, do you really think it's desirable to have one employee waiting a few minutes for data to open while another waits just a second or two? Aren't all account books created equal? Doesn't your business deserve the same amount of productivity from all your employees?

The fastest solution is to make sure that all people in a department have machines with the same configuration, and you'll even get a bulk-buying discount! So is the answer an upgrade?

After some reflection, you will see that "Cutting The Fat" is exactly what you need to do. Every employee does *not* need a 40 or 80 or

